PHILOSOPHY AND CURRENT ISSUES
MPU 3192 / 3193

Group Report

Topic: Sexual abuse

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Lecturer:

Students' Declaration:

We declare that all materials in this assignment are our work except where there is clear acknowledgment or reference to the work of others, and we have complied and agreed to the University rules and regulations on Plagiarism and Academic Integrity.

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A. Introduction of sexual abuse

B. Objectives

The primary aim of this report is to present a complete analysis of sexual abuse through both philosophical and sociological perspectives because it represents a major social problem that threatens to destroy Malaysian society's fundamental moral principles.

- **Investigation of fundamental causes** The research will identify the fundamental causes of sexual abuse through investigation into power imbalances, gender-based hierarchies, and societal misconceptions which create systemic conditions for abuse to occur.

- **Connection to philosophical systems** The study examines root causes of the problem to establish connections between it and established philosophical systems which explore ethical principles, human nature, and cultural thought processes.

- **Impact on societal health** This report investigates how sexual abuse affects societal health through its impact on victims and their families which extends to the entire community.

- **Application of National Education Philosophy** The evaluation uses the National Education Philosophy definition of a "balanced human" concept to analyze how trauma affects the intellectual, emotional, and spiritual balance of a person.

- **Development of integrated solutions** The study develops integrated solutions which combine strong legal standards with advanced educational changes and philosophical methods for handling intercultural communication.

- **Establishment of a strategic plan** The report establishes a strategic plan which will increase shared values within the community while building ethical strength to stop sexual abuse from happening in the future.

C. Definition of sexual abuse

In this report, defines sexual abuse as all sexual acts which occur without a person granting their consent. The process involves two methods which include physical force and online deception through cyber-grooming to obtain through threats and deception. The act of breaking a law represents more than just a criminal offense because it shows complete disrespect for another person's human rights and dignity. The definition needs to be established because it shows how current thinking patterns of our society constitute a distorted way of thinking.

Another important term is consent. The definition indicates that all participants must express their agreement through clear and voluntary yes statements. In our country, the Rukun Negara (National Principles) teaches us about Kesopanan dan Kesusilaan (Good Behavior and Morality), and consent is a huge part of that. The practice involves maintaining personal standards of integrity while showing respect toward other individuals. Human rights violation occurs in situations that lack consent.

The Social Science Theory serves as our final method which we will use to analyze the situation. The process involves applying academic "lenses" which include theories about power dynamics and social organization to investigate the origins of these criminal activities. Theoretical frameworks enable us to investigate how environmental factors and thought processes about decolonization will lead to shifts in human behavior throughout contemporary society.

D. Causes of sexual abuse

E. Impacts of sexual abuse on the society

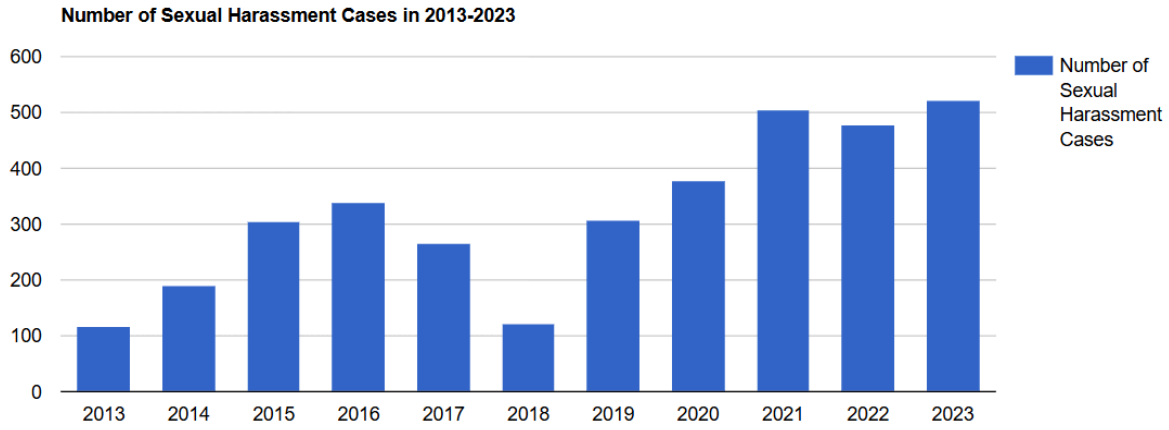
Sexual abuse has profound and far-reaching consequences that extend beyond individual survivors to families, institutions, and society as a whole. At the personal level, survivors often experience long-term psychological trauma, including depression, anxiety, post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), and feelings of guilt or shame. These impacts can disrupt education, employment, and relationships, reducing overall quality of life. Physical health may also be affected, with survivors facing increased risks of chronic illness, substance abuse, and reproductive health complications.

The effects ripple outward into families and communities. Survivors' trauma can strain family cohesion, erode trust, and create cycles of silence or stigma that discourage disclosure. Communities may struggle with the social costs of untreated trauma, including reduced productivity and increased healthcare burdens. Institutions that fail to protect individuals or respond adequately to abuse face a loss of public confidence, damaging their credibility and legitimacy.

On a societal scale, sexual abuse undermines social cohesion and imposes significant economic costs through healthcare, legal processes, and lost productivity. Yet, survivors' resilience and advocacy have also driven systemic reforms, highlighting the importance of prevention, accountability, and support services. Addressing sexual abuse requires not only strong law enforcement but also comprehensive education, survivor-centered care, and institutional transparency.

Ultimately, the impacts of sexual abuse demonstrate that it is not merely a private issue but a societal crisis demanding collective responsibility and sustained action.

F. Statistic of sexual abuse in malaysia



Based on the statistics, there was a noticeable decline in reported sexual harassment cases between 2016 and 2018. This reduction may be attributed to increased law enforcement efforts, public awareness campaigns, and stronger institutional measures aimed at addressing sexual misconduct. However, from 2018 onwards, the number of cases began to rise again, reaching significant peaks in 2021 and 2023.

One possible explanation for this upward trend is the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic. During periods of lockdown, individuals were confined to their homes, which may have heightened risks of domestic abuse and harassment. Additionally, the stress and isolation associated with the pandemic could have exacerbated harmful behaviors. It is also important to note that greater awareness and advocacy during this period may have encouraged more survivors to come forward and report incidents, contributing to the increase in recorded cases.

Overall, while enforcement and awareness efforts have shown some effectiveness, the data highlights the need for sustained preventive strategies, stronger support systems for survivors, and continued education to reduce sexual harassment in Malaysia.

G. Summary.

Hari Prasad Govinda (4 Journal)

A review of academic journals, Malaysian report and news articles shows that sexual abuse is a complex issue influenced by cultural, institutional, and psychological factors.

First, Finkelhor (2009) explains that sexual abuse is strongly linked to power imbalance and lack of supervision. Individuals who hold authority—such as parents, relatives, teachers, or employers—are more likely to exploit their position when there is minimal oversight. This is especially relevant in Malaysia, where many cases occur within familiar environments. The study highlights that abuse is rarely random; instead, it often happens in situations where perpetrators have easy access to victims and can manipulate or control them.

Secondly , research by Noor & Rahman (2018) in Malaysia highlights that many sexual abuse cases involve perpetrators who are known to the victim, such as family members or acquaintances. This finding is consistent with reports from *The Star (2023)*, which stated that most abuse cases occur in familiar environments rather than by strangers. This challenges the common misconception that sexual abuse is mainly caused by unknown offenders.

Thirdly, Ahmad et al. (2020) examined the psychological effects of sexual abuse among Malaysian survivors and found that victims commonly suffer from long-term trauma, including depression, anxiety, and low self-esteem. These findings are aligned with global studies such as WHO (2021), which emphasize that sexual abuse has lifelong mental health consequences.

In addition, several studies suggest that education plays a crucial role in prevention. Research by Rahman and Karim (2022) shows that individuals who receive proper education about consent, boundaries, and personal safety are less likely to become victims. Awareness programs in schools and communities help individuals recognise abusive behaviour and take appropriate action.

H. Analyze of sexual abuse

Social Learning Theory, developed by Bandura (1977), explains that individuals acquire behaviour through observation, imitation, and reinforcement within their social environment. In the context of sexual abuse, this theory suggests that individuals who are exposed to violent or inappropriate behaviour—whether in the family, community, or media—may learn and replicate such actions. For instance, repeated exposure to pornography or harmful online content can gradually normalise aggressive or non-consensual behaviour, shaping an individual's understanding of relationships and consent. Furthermore, when abusive actions are not punished or are ignored, they may be reinforced and repeated over time. A person who grows up in an environment where abuse is present or tolerated may begin to perceive such behaviour as acceptable or normal. Therefore, Social Learning Theory highlights the importance of preventive measures such as promoting positive role models, providing education on consent and healthy relationships, and regulating exposure to harmful media content. These efforts can help reduce the likelihood of individuals adopting abusive behaviours (Bandura, 1977).

I. Group reflection of sexual abuse

Through this study, we realised that sexual abuse is not just a personal issue but a societal problem that requires collective action. Awareness, education, and support systems are essential in addressing this issue.

We also learned that victims need a safe and supportive environment to come forward. As students, we believe that promoting respect and consent is crucial in preventing abuse.

ABILASH

Through this study I acquired a better understanding of how sexual abuse represents a breakdown in the moral fabric of our society. The group established that this problem requires collective awareness and support but I discovered that power and respect issues arise from a distorted "culture of thought" which exists in our society. The project showed me that National Education Philosophy defines "balanced human" as someone who needs emotional and spiritual development to protect other people's rights beyond their academic knowledge. I now believe that practicing the National Principles of Kesopanan dan Kesusilaan (Morality and Good Behavior) together with others will help us develop a community which always upholds the practice of required consent. The research demonstrated to me that my educational path and professional journey require me to create safe spaces while upholding ethical standards which will stop future misconduct from occurring.

J. Conclusion

K. References

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